

INGREDIENT

1. Passage anchor

> “I would need to think about **ingredients**, packaging, food safety, delivery...”

Passage meaning

ingredient = one of the foods or substances used to make a dish or product

材料；食材；配料

Here, the speaker means the individual food items needed to make cookies, brownies, cakes, and other desserts.

Practice

1. Good **ingredients** make a big difference in baking.

優質**食材**會令烘焙成品有很大差別。

2. I would need to calculate the cost of every **ingredient**.

我需要計算每種**材料**的成本。

Core meanings of INGREDIENT

2. ingredient — food component

= one of the foods or substances combined to make a dish, drink, or recipe

食材；配料；材料

This is the exact passage sense.

Examples

1. Flour is one of the main **ingredients** in the recipe.

麵粉是這個食譜的主要**材料**之一。

2. Mix all the **ingredients** in a large bowl.

把所有**材料**放進大碗裡混合。

3. main ingredient

= most important or largest component in a food or product

****主要成分；主要食材****

Examples

1. Chocolate is the main ****ingredient**** in these brownies.

巧克力是這些布朗尼的主要****材料****。

2. Rice is the main ****ingredient**** in the dish.

米是這道菜的主要****食材****。

Product / substance composition

4. ingredient — component of a product

= one of the substances used to make a medicine, cosmetic, cleaning product, etc.

****成分；原料****

Examples

1. Check the ****ingredients**** in the shampoo.

查看洗髮水中的****成分****。

2. The product contains several natural ****ingredients****.

這個產品含有幾種天然****成分****。

This extends beyond food.

5. ingredients list

= list showing substances contained in a food or product

****成分表；配料表****

Examples

1. Read the ****ingredients list**** before buying the product.

購買產品前先閱讀****成分表****。

2. Sugar appears near the top of the ****ingredients list****.

糖在****配料表****中排得很前。

Figurative component / factor

6. ingredient — necessary factor

= one of the elements or factors needed to produce a particular result

****要素；因素；條件****

Examples

1. Trust is an important ****ingredient**** in a strong relationship.

信任是穩固關係中的重要****要素****。

2. Patience is a key ****ingredient**** for success.

耐性是成功的重要****因素****。

Major figurative sense.

7. key ingredient

A. literal

= especially important food/product component

****關鍵成分；主要材料****

1. Butter is a key ****ingredient**** in the recipe.

牛油是這個食譜的****關鍵材料****。

B. figurative

= especially important factor in achieving something

****關鍵要素****

2. Consistency is a key ****ingredient**** in building a business.

穩定性是建立生意的****關鍵要素****。

8. essential ingredient

= necessary component or factor

****必要成分；必要要素****

Examples

1. Water is an **essential ingredient** in the mixture.

水是這個混合物中的**必要成分**。

2. Communication is an **essential ingredient** of teamwork.

溝通是團隊合作的**必要要素**。

Medicine / chemistry

9. active ingredient

= substance in a medicine or product that produces its main intended effect

有效成分；活性成分

Examples

1. Check the **active ingredient** in the medicine.

查看藥物中的**有效成分**。

2. The cream contains an **active ingredient** that reduces inflammation.

這款藥膏含有能減輕炎症的**活性成分**。

Very high-value technical/common label sense.

10. inactive ingredient

= substance included in a medicine that does not provide the main therapeutic effect

非活性成分；賦形劑成分

Examples

1. The label also lists the **inactive ingredients**.

標籤亦列出**非活性成分**。

2. Some people may react to an **inactive ingredient**.

有些人可能會對某種**非活性成分**產生反應。

Recipe / formula language

11. ingredient for something

= component or factor used to create a result

****製作.....的材料；促成.....的要素****

Examples

1. Eggs are an important ****ingredient for**** many cakes.

雞蛋是很多蛋糕的重要****材料****。

2. Mutual respect is an ****ingredient for**** a healthy partnership.

互相尊重是健康合作關係的一項重要****要素****。

Related forms

12. ingredient-based

= organized or described according to ingredients

****以成分為基礎的****

Examples

1. The menu includes ****ingredient-based**** information.

菜單包括****按成分分類的資訊****。

2. Some customers prefer ****ingredient-based**** labels.

有些顧客較喜歡****按成分標示的標籤****。

Lower priority, but transparent.

High-value figurative patterns

13. recipe for success

Not a direct ****ingredient**** form, but highly related metaphorically.

= combination of factors likely to produce success

****成功的配方；成功要素組合****

Examples

1. Hard work and timing can be a ****recipe for success****.

努力加上時機可以成為****成功的配方****。

2. Quality and consistency are important ingredients in that ****recipe for success****.
品質和穩定性是這套****成功配方****的重要要素。

14. ingredients for success

= factors needed to succeed

****成功要素****

Examples

1. Discipline and patience are important ****ingredients for success****.

自律和耐性是重要的****成功要素****。

2. The business already has several ****ingredients for success****.

這門生意已經具備幾項****成功條件****。

Key contrasts

15. ingredient vs material

****ingredient****

= component combined with others to make a food, product, mixture, or result

****材料；成分****

****material****

= broader term for substance or resource used to make something

****材料；物料****

Compare:

> cake ingredients

> 蛋糕食材

> building materials

> 建築材料

16. ingredient vs component

****component****

= part of a larger system, machine, product, or whole

****組成部分；元件****

****ingredient****

= substance mixed into something, or figuratively a factor contributing to a result

****成分；要素****

Compare:

> electronic component

> 電子元件

> active ingredient

> 有效成分

17. ingredient vs element

****element****

= broad word for one part/aspect of something

****元素；要素****

****ingredient****

= often suggests something combined with other things to produce an outcome

Compare:

> an element of risk

> 一項風險因素

> a key ingredient for success

> 成功的關鍵要素

18. ingredient vs factor

****factor****

= circumstance or condition influencing a result

****因素****

****ingredient****

= more metaphorical and often suggests one of several elements needed together

Compare:

> cost is an important factor

> 成本是重要因素

> trust is a key ingredient

> 信任是關鍵要素

19. ingredient vs additive

****ingredient****

= any component of a food/product

****成分****

****additive****

= substance added for a specific purpose, often in relatively small quantities

****添加劑****

Not every ingredient is an additive.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****ingredient**** is:

****one thing combined with others to create a whole****

From this develop:

Passage

ingredients for baking

→ ****烘焙食材 / 材料****

Product

cosmetic ingredients

→ ****產品成分****

Medicine

active ingredient

→ ****有效成分****

Then figuratively:

Success

ingredient for success

→ **成功要素**

Relationship

trust as an ingredient

→ **關係中的重要因素**

So the literal-to-figurative extension is very natural:

> several ingredients combine to make a cake

> → 多種食材組成蛋糕

figuratively:

> several qualities combine to create success

> → 多項要素共同促成成功

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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ingredient — food	用來製作食物、飲品的其中一種食材 / 配料
main ingredient	在食物或產品中最主要的成分 / 食材
ingredient — product component	化妝品、藥物、清潔用品等所含的一種成分 / 原料
ingredients list	列出食品 / 產品所含成分的配料表 / 成分表
ingredient — figurative factor	共同促成某種結果的其中一項要素 / 因素
key ingredient — literal	產品 / 食譜中的關鍵成分
key ingredient — figurative	促成成功、關係等的重要關鍵要素
essential ingredient	必不可少的成分 / 必要要素
active ingredient	在藥物 / 產品中產生主要作用的有效 / 活性成分
inactive ingredient	不產生主要療效的非活性成分
ingredient for something	用來構成某物的材料；或促成某結果的要素
ingredients for success	促成成功所需要的各項條件 / 要素

Passage recap

> “I would need to think about **ingredients**, packaging, food safety, delivery...”

Here:

****ingredients**** = ****the individual food materials used to make the desserts****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****食材****

* ****材料****

* ****配料****

Natural contextual translation:

****我需要考慮食材、包裝、食物安全、送貨安排等。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****ingredient****

= ****one of the substances or foods combined to make a dish, product, or mixture****

****食材；配料；成分****

The most important figurative extension is:

> ****ingredient in a cake****

> → 蛋糕中的食材

but:

> ****ingredient for success****

> → ****成功要素****

And in medicine:

> ****active ingredient****

> → ****有效成分****

So ****ingredient**** is not massively polysemous, but it has a clean, useful movement from ****literal composition**** to ****figurative contributing factor****.